

Career Chart After 12th: Science

PCM, PCB and PCMB routes, seat odds, fee maths and a second plan

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Science keeps the most doors open and has the scarcest seats. Write a second route before results, not after.

PCM and PCB at a glance

Science (PCM) · Physics, Chemistry, Maths

- B.Tech / BE: JEE Main, JEE Advanced, state tests
- BCA, BSc Computer Science, Data Science
- Architecture: JEE Main Paper 2 or NATA
- NDA: Army, Navy and Air Force
- Design, BBA, law and CA also open

Science (PCB) · Physics, Chemistry, Biology

- MBBS and BDS: NEET UG
- BSc Nursing, physiotherapy, allied health
- B.Pharm, biotech, life sciences
- Psychology, nutrition, forensic science
- Design, BBA, law and CA also open

How to read each science combination

PCM: Engineering is one door, not the only door

PCM keeps the widest set of doors open: B.Tech, BCA, data science, architecture, NDA (Navy and Air Force), and all the any-stream routes. If JEE goes badly, a computer or data degree plus one shipped project is a strong second plan.

PCB: NEET is a large gate with a small opening

MBBS seats total 1,36,939 for 2026-27, against over 22 lakh registrations. Write a full second plan (nursing, allied health, pharmacy, biotech or a data pivot) before the result, not after it.

PCMB: Two subjects give you two backups

If you studied both Maths and Biology, you can attempt NEET and JEE routes. That also means double the preparation load, so pick a primary exam early.

Science routes row by row

ROUTE	WHO CAN APPLY	ENTRY GATE	LENGTH	PAY SIGNAL	THE CATCH
B.Tech / BE in computer, data or electronics	PCM (Maths is compulsory)	JEE Main, JEE Advanced, state and private tests	4 years	Software fresher pay averages about ₹5.4 lakh but ranges widely by college and skill	A branch or college label alone does not get hired. A visible project does.
BCA, BSc Computer Science or data science	Most colleges want Maths or Computer Science in 12th; check each one	CUET UG or a college test	3 years (4 in many four-year honours programmes)	Data analyst fresher pay averages about ₹4.1 lakh	Cheaper than B.Tech, but the degree carries less brand weight, so proof of work matters more.
Design: B.Des, fashion, interior, UX	Any stream	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT entrance and college tests	4 years	Graphic designer fresher pay averages about ₹2.4 lakh; a strong portfolio moves it up	Admission tests reward drawing and thinking speed. Prepare a portfolio early.
MBBS, BDS and allied health	PCB with English	NEET UG (over 22 lakh registered for 2026)	MBBS about 5.5 years including internship; postgraduate study adds more	Income grows late, after specialisation	Two hard gates: NEET, then postgraduate seats. Fees at private colleges can be very high.
BSc Nursing, B.Pharm, physiotherapy	PCB for nursing and physiotherapy; PCB or PCM for B.Pharm	State counselling, university tests and college tests	4 years	Nurse fresher pay averages about ₹2.6 lakh; pharmacist about ₹2.5 lakh	Licence and registration rules apply. Pay rises through specialisation, not time alone.

ROUTE	WHO CAN APPLY	ENTRY GATE	LENGTH	PAY SIGNAL	THE CATCH
Defence: NDA	Army: any stream. Navy and Air Force: Physics and Maths	UPSC NDA exam, then SSB interview and medical tests	Academy training, then service	Paid training and stable service pay	NDA II 2026 had only 394 vacancies. Medical and height standards are strict.

Seats against applicants

NEET UG 2026: MBBS seats per 100 registered candidates



About 6

1,36,939 MBBS seats against over 22 lakh registrations. Around 11.2 lakh qualified in the re-exam.

JEE Advanced 2026: IIT seats per 100 qualified candidates



About 33

18,826 IIT seats (18,951 with IISc Bangalore) in the JoSAA matrix against 56,880 qualified, out of 1,87,389 who registered.

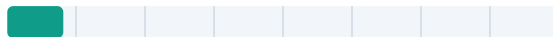
NEET UG 2026: government MBBS seats per 100 test-takers



About 3

63,296 government seats against about 20 lakh who appeared. Private colleges hold the other 73,643 seats, and those cost far more.

JEE Advanced 2026: IIT seats per 100 who appeared in both papers



About 10

18,826 IIT seats against 1,79,694 candidates who appeared. Only about 32 in 100 of them qualified, and qualifying does not guarantee a seat in the branch you want.

JoSAA 2026: total IIT, NIT, IIIT and GFTI seats



67,323

Many more seats exist than IIT seats, which is why a strong non-IIT plan is a real plan, not a consolation.

What the seat costs

SEAT	FEE	THE MATHS	BUDGET RULE (FEE ÷ 0.10)
IIT B.Tech, general category	Tuition ₹1,28,250 per semester (₹28,250 for SC, ST and PwD). Hostel and mess are extra.	₹1,28,250 × 8 semesters = about ₹10.3 lakh of tuition. Against the PayScale entry software average of ₹5.37 lakh, that is about 1.9 years of that pay, before living costs.	About ₹1 crore (₹10.3 lakh ÷ 0.10)
MBBS, government quota	Under ₹8 lakh for the whole course in the states compared	Only about 3 government seats per 100 NEET test-takers, so the fee is low and the competition is the real price.	About ₹80 lakh (₹8 lakh ÷ 0.10)
MBBS, private management quota	Above ₹60 lakh for the whole course in the states compared	At least 7.5 times the government total (₹60 lakh ÷ ₹8 lakh). The seat is easier to get and far harder to repay.	About ₹6 crore (₹60 lakh ÷ 0.10)

The budget rule is a strict planning heuristic: keep the total education cost near 10% of the money you can commit, and protect the rest as runway.

Exam dates to note

ENGINEERING

JEE Main 2027 Session 1: 22 to 24 and 28 to 30 January 2027

These are the dates in the NTA examination calendar, with 31 January as a buffer day. NTA calls the calendar tentative, and the Session 2 dates and the application window are not announced yet.

NOT ANNOUNCED

NEET UG 2027, CUET UG 2027 and the next NDA cycle

NTA's calendar for December 2026 to March 2027 does not list NEET UG or CUET UG. NDA II 2026 was held on 13 September 2026. Wait for each official notice before planning around a date.

Read the chart by your exam result

If the exam goes well

- Use counselling to compare colleges by course, fees and placement median, not by name alone.
- Budget the whole course before you accept a seat, including hostel and coaching.
- Start one small skill project before college begins so first year is not empty.

If the exam goes averagely

- Apply to a route where your score is enough today, such as a good BCA, BBA or allied-health seat.
- Keep the entrance exam as a later option through CUET, lateral entry or postgraduate tests.
- Choose the college for teaching quality and internship access, not for the campus photos.

If the exam goes badly

- Check what actually caused it: preparation, health, stress or the wrong exam for you.
- A drop year is worth it only with a fixed score target, a plan for money and a written skill-building side track.
- Exams can also be disrupted. NEET UG 2026 was cancelled and re-held on 21 June 2026 after paper-leak allegations, so a second plan protects you from more than a bad day.

Test every shortlisted route: 4 checkpoints, then 3 gates

1 Biology

How do you actually work best: abstract study, business thinking, people, or tools and systems? Choose the daily reality, not the label.

2 Context

Marks, money, family situation, school options, commute and emotional readiness. A route right on paper can be wrong for now.

3 Market

Where does the route lead later: real roles, real skills, real progression? Map it forward before you choose.

4 Survival

Will it hold up in an AI-shaped market? Domain skill plus communication, digital fluency and judgment lasts longer than routine work.

5 Proof of Skill

Complete one small real task that resembles the route before you lock it.

6 Proof of Communication

Explain in 30 to 90 seconds why the route fits you, where it leads and what you will test next.

7 Proof of Value

Get grounded feedback from a teacher, senior or professional who does this work, and pressure-test your reasoning.

Your one-page plan

Three routes I shortlisted:

The entry gate and date I verified, and where:

My second route if the exam goes badly:

One small real task I will finish this month:

Two people inside the route I will ask:

Read this first: Seat numbers, exam dates, fees and pay figures change every year and differ by state and college. Use this chart to compare routes, then confirm each date and rule on the official exam site before you act.

The route is the base layer. The skill portfolio on top raises your ceiling.

Check your fit with the free career assessments: futurecareerschool.com/services/assessments/

Personal help for you and your family: futurecareerschool.com/services/career-counselling-and-career-guidance/ · WhatsApp message from the site.

Full guide with explanations: futurecareerschool.com/blog/career-options/career-chart-after-12th/